

A PREMIUM PROMPT COLLECTION

THE AI **PROMPT** **VAULT**

20 prompts designed to give you the kind of insight you'd get from an exceptional therapist, executive coach, or life strategist.

20

PROMPTS

5

CATEGORIES

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CHAPTER 1

Mental Clarity & Decision Making

5 Prompts

The Avoidance Decoder

I'm going to tell you about a decision I've been avoiding. Don't help me make it — first, tell me why I'm avoiding it. What am I actually afraid of? Be uncomfortably specific. Look for the fear underneath the fear. Then tell me what the version of me who already made this decision would say to current me. Here's the decision:

[describe in one sentence]

WHEN TO USE

When you've been "thinking about" the same decision for weeks and haven't moved.

HOW IT WORKS

Forces the AI to diagnose the emotional block before offering solutions, which is what actually unsticks people.

The Clarity Interrogation

I feel stuck and I don't know what I want. I'm going to describe my current situation in a few sentences. Your job is to ask me 7 increasingly specific questions that expose what I actually want but haven't admitted to myself yet. Don't give me advice — just ask questions that make me uncomfortable. Make each question build on my previous answer. Here's where I am: **[2-3 sentences about your situation]**

WHEN TO USE

When you're "confused" but suspect you actually know what you want and are just scared to admit it.

HOW IT WORKS

Uses Socratic questioning to surface the truth you're hiding from yourself, not the socially acceptable version.

The Rumination Breaker

I've been overthinking the same thing for days and going in circles. Describe my thought pattern as if you were a therapist watching it from the outside — what am I actually doing here psychologically? What function does this rumination serve for me? Then tell me the one question I should answer to actually resolve this, not just think about it more. Here's what I keep thinking about: **[describe the loop]**

WHEN TO USE

When you catch yourself having the same mental conversation for the third day in a row.

HOW IT WORKS

Reframes obsessive thinking as a coping mechanism rather than productive analysis, which breaks the spell.

The Gut Check Translator

I'm going to describe a situation where my gut is telling me something but I keep intellectualizing it away. Act as a translator between my intuition and my rational mind. What is my gut actually trying to tell me? What would need to be true for my rational objections to be wrong? Be specific about what I'm sensing but not naming. Here's the situation: **[describe what feels "off"]**

WHEN TO USE

When you have a persistent bad feeling about something but "can't explain why."

HOW IT WORKS

Legitimizes intuitive knowledge and forces articulation of the pattern recognition your subconscious has already done.

The Sunk Cost Detector

I'm going to tell you about something I'm continuing to invest time, money, or energy into. Analyze whether I'm doing this because it's actually valuable or because I've already invested so much I can't admit it's not working. Be brutally honest about what I'm getting out of this versus what I tell myself I'm getting out of it. If this is a sunk cost fallacy, tell me what I'm afraid will be true about me if I quit. Here's what I'm invested in: **[describe the situation]**

WHEN TO USE

When you defend something you're doing with "but I've already spent so much..." or "I'm so close..."

HOW IT WORKS

Separates identity protection from rational assessment, which is the only way to quit things that aren't working.

CHAPTER 2

Career & Money Reality Check

4 Prompts

The Underpaid Wake-Up Call

I'm going to tell you my current role, years of experience, and rough salary. Your job is to tell me — with evidence — if I'm underpaid, and if so, by how much and why. Don't sugarcoat it. Then tell me the actual market rate for someone with my profile and what specific leverage I have that I'm not using. Finally, tell me the real reason I've accepted being underpaid if that's what's happening. Here's my situation: [role, experience, salary range]

WHEN TO USE

When you suspect you're underpaid but keep finding reasons not to check or negotiate.

HOW IT WORKS

Provides external calibration on worth, which people systematically underestimate for themselves, especially women.

The Career Narrative Audit

I'm going to give you my work history in bullet points. Your job is to tell me the story I'm actually telling with my career choices versus the story I probably tell myself. What pattern do you see? What am I optimizing for, really? What am I running from? Be specific about the through-line I can't see because I'm inside it. Then tell me what this pattern suggests I should do next if I want something different. Here's my history: **[list last 3-5 roles with brief context]**

WHEN TO USE

When your career feels like a series of random moves rather than a coherent path.

HOW IT WORKS

Reveals unconscious career strategies and whether they're actually serving your goals or protecting you from something.

The Competence Delusion Check

I'm going to describe a skill or area where I think I'm pretty good. Your job is to assess whether I'm actually good or just haven't been challenged enough to realize I'm mediocre. Ask me 5 specific questions about how I know I'm good at this — questions that would expose whether I'm comparing myself to a weak reference group or have genuine evidence. Be skeptical. Don't be nice about this. Here's what I think I'm good at:

[describe the skill/area]

WHEN TO USE

Before claiming expertise in something, especially on a resume or in a negotiation.

HOW IT WORKS

Stress-tests self-assessment against real standards rather than local comparisons, which is how people plateau.

The Golden Handcuffs Evaluator

I make good money but I'm not happy in my work. I'm going to describe my situation. Your job is to calculate what I'm actually trading my happiness for in concrete terms — not just "financial security" but the actual lifestyle elements the money provides. Then tell me which of those things I could give up without my life meaningfully getting worse, and which are non-negotiable. Be specific about what I'm afraid of losing. Here's my situation: **[current role, salary, lifestyle, what you'd rather be doing]**

WHEN TO USE

When you say "I can't afford to leave" but haven't actually done the math on what you need versus want.

HOW IT WORKS

Separates real financial constraints from lifestyle inflation and identity investments disguised as necessities.

CHAPTER 3

Relationships & Communication

5 Prompts

The Conflict Pattern Diagnosis

I'm going to describe a recent conflict or argument I had with someone important to me. Don't tell me who was right or wrong. Instead, tell me what role I always play in conflicts like this — am I the avoider, the escalator, the victim, the fixer? What am I optimizing for when I fight this way, and what am I sacrificing? Be specific about the pattern, not just this instance. Here's what happened: **[describe the conflict]**

WHEN TO USE

When you notice the same type of fight happening with different people.

HOW IT WORKS

Identifies your conflict fingerprint across relationships, which is invisible to you but obvious to everyone else.

The Relationship Autopsy

I'm going to describe a relationship that ended or changed significantly. Don't comfort me or say it was mutual or meant to be. Tell me what I did to contribute to this outcome — the specific behaviors, choices, or patterns. What did I optimize for that made this inevitable? What did I ignore? Be honest about the part I don't want to own. Then tell me what I'll repeat in my next relationship if I don't address this. Here's what happened:

[describe the relationship and ending]

WHEN TO USE

After any significant relationship ends, especially if you find yourself telling a story where you did nothing wrong.

HOW IT WORKS

Breaks the victim narrative and forces accountability for patterns, which is the only way to stop repeating them.

The Hard Conversation Script

I need to have a difficult conversation with someone and I keep putting it off. I'm going to describe the situation and what I need to say. Your job is to tell me what I'm actually afraid will happen if I say this — the real fear, not the surface one. Then write me the first three sentences I should say to open this conversation in a way that makes the other person want to engage rather than defend. Make it sound like me, not a corporate HR script. Here's the situation: **[describe what you need to say and to whom]**

WHEN TO USE

When you know you need to have a conversation and keep finding reasons to wait.

HOW IT WORKS

Names the avoidance mechanism and provides a tactical starting point, which eliminates the two main blockers to hard conversations.

The Friendship Audit

I'm going to list my closest 5-7 friendships and one sentence about each. Your job is to tell me what I'm optimizing for in friendship based on who I've chosen. What do these people have in common? What do I get from these friendships, and what am I not getting? Who am I staying friends with out of habit or guilt rather than genuine connection? Be specific about what my friend group reveals about what I value or what I'm avoiding. Here's my list: **[list friends with brief descriptions]**

WHEN TO USE

When your social life feels obligatory rather than energizing, or when you suspect you've outgrown your friend group.

HOW IT WORKS

Reveals unconscious friendship selection criteria and identifies relationships that have expired but haven't ended.

The Boundary Failure Analysis

I'm going to describe a situation where I said yes but should have said no, or where someone crossed a line and I didn't stop them. Don't tell me I need to set boundaries — I know that. Instead, tell me what I was afraid would happen if I said no. What do I believe about myself or the relationship that makes me think I can't enforce this boundary? Be specific about the underlying belief that's actually running this behavior. Here's what happened: **[describe the boundary violation]**

WHEN TO USE

After you agree to something and immediately feel resentful, or when you notice a pattern of being walked over.

HOW IT WORKS

Identifies the core belief that makes boundary-setting feel dangerous rather than just uncomfortable.

CHAPTER 4

Identity & Direction

4 Prompts

The Identity Crisis Translator

I feel lost, like I don't know who I am or what I'm doing with my life. I'm going to describe how I spend my time and what I say I value. Your job is to tell me who I actually am based on my actions, not my aspirations. What identity am I performing versus living? What have I built my sense of self around that's not actually me? Be uncomfortably specific about the gap between who I say I am and what my life demonstrates. Here's what I do and what I say I value: **[describe both]**

WHEN TO USE

When you feel like you're living someone else's life or don't recognize yourself anymore.

HOW IT WORKS

Forces reconciliation between performed identity and lived reality, which is where existential dread actually comes from.

The Deathbed Scenario

I'm 80 years old, looking back at my life. I continued exactly the path I'm on now, made the safe choices, avoided the scary ones. Describe the specific regrets I have. Not vague "I wish I'd traveled more" — concrete, personal regrets based on who I am and what I'm actually avoiding right now. Make it hurt. Then tell me what I need to do in the next 6 months to ensure at least one of those regrets doesn't happen. Here's my current path: **[describe where you're headed if nothing changes]**

WHEN TO USE

When you're choosing comfort over risk and telling yourself "someday."

HOW IT WORKS

Makes future regret visceral and immediate rather than abstract, which is the only way it affects present behavior.

The Envy Decoder

I'm going to tell you about 2-3 people I'm jealous of and specifically what about their lives I envy. Don't tell me jealousy is bad or that I should be grateful for what I have. Instead, tell me what my envy is revealing about what I actually want for myself. What am I not letting myself pursue that I'm watching other people have? Be specific about what desire I'm suppressing and why. Here's who I'm jealous of and why: **[describe each person and what triggers the jealousy]**

WHEN TO USE

When you feel bitter or resentful scrolling social media, or when someone else's success genuinely bothers you.

HOW IT WORKS

Reframes envy as directional data about suppressed desires rather than a character flaw to be managed.

The Purpose Pressure Release

I feel like I should have some grand purpose or calling and I don't, which makes me feel like I'm wasting my life. I'm going to describe what I actually enjoy doing and what naturally holds my attention. Your job is to tell me if I'm chasing someone else's definition of meaningful or if there's something real I'm missing. Give me permission to want what I actually want, or show me the purpose I'm already living but not counting. Be specific about what "shoulds" I'm carrying that aren't mine. Here's what actually engages me: **[describe what you naturally gravitate toward]**

WHEN TO USE

When you feel guilty about not having big ambitions or when your actual interests feel too small to count.

HOW IT WORKS

Separates authentic purpose from inherited narratives about what a meaningful life looks like.

CHAPTER 5

Habits & Energy

2 Prompts

The Willpower Myth Buster

I'm going to tell you about a habit I keep trying to build but can't stick to. Don't give me tips on habit formation or tell me to start smaller. Instead, diagnose why I actually don't want to do this thing despite saying I do. What am I getting out of NOT doing it? What would I have to face or give up if I actually did it consistently? Be specific about the hidden payoff of failure. Here's the habit: **[describe what you keep failing at]**

WHEN TO USE

When you've tried to build the same habit five times and it never sticks.

HOW IT WORKS

Reveals that habit failure is usually about conflicting desires, not insufficient discipline, which changes the whole approach.

The Energy Audit

I'm tired all the time and don't know why. I'm going to list how I spend my time in a typical week and who I spend it with. Your job is to identify what's actually draining me — not just "lack of sleep" but the specific activities, people, or environments that are depleting my energy. Then tell me what I'm doing that makes me feel energized but I'm not prioritizing. Be specific about the ROI of my time. Here's my typical week: **[describe your schedule and regular activities]**

WHEN TO USE

When you're constantly exhausted despite "getting enough sleep" or when rest doesn't actually restore you.

HOW IT WORKS

Maps energy flows to reveal mismatches between how you spend time and what actually sustains you.

Stop Avoiding. **Start Asking.**

Pick the prompt that matches what you're avoiding
thinking about.

Copy it. Fill in the bracket. Be honest.

The discomfort means it's working.

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